advice, he immediately picks out something triple-A which can't possibly make the buyer any money and has only a small chance of losing any. He cannot be stampeded into unwary speculation by the hysteria of a boom. He reminds me of what I once heard one doctor say of another: "He doesn't know enough medicine to do a patient any harm."

He sits tight through '26, '27, and '28. Unfortunately, he begins to come in cautiously in '29. (Watching these young whippersnappers make fortunes for three long years does something to the sturdiest characters.) But he pulls out again, and, while a nice piece of money is lost, no one is ruined. He apologizes to himself for having had a human moment and resumes his thirty-year-old policy of listening attentively and saying no.

Way back, generations ago, when it was smart to be tough, the original hundred millions were gathered together in some more realistic business—say, selling firewater to the Indians. And these present grandsons of fortune, sitting up there in a courteous trance, are perhaps not so dumb as they look. I just suspect that they think the buying and selling of securities is a worse occupation than I think it is. But they don't write articles about it; they just avoid it as much as they can without losing the franchise.

We next come to partners, customers' men, heads of trading departments, and statisticians. These gentlemen think steadily and rapidly for five and a half days a week, and when they start losing people's money they really lose it. Their own, too.

Partners as a rule are more impressive than customers' men, because they usually have small private offices, sometimes paneled in oak, in which to have their Thoughts, while the customers' men have to spawn theirs in public out in the board room. The type of customer who habitually sits in a board room is frequently just a gent who loves to chat in masculine company but who doesn't belong to a club. This makes the board room a difficult place for profound thinking.